

KCA UNIVERSITY

SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY

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TASK: IN ATLEAST FOUR PAGES CRITIQUE THE TECHNOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT
IN COMMUNICATION IN THE WORLD WE LIVE IN TODAY.

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Introduction and the Double-Edged Sword of Connectivity

The contemporary landscape of communication is characterized by instantaneity, driven by the relentless march of digital technology, from smartphones and social media to advanced video conferencing. The shift from traditional methods like postal mail and landline phones to internet-based communication has virtually erased the constraints of time and distance, creating a “global village” where interactions across continents are a daily reality. This unprecedented connectivity has revolutionized business, education and personal relationships, allowing for seamless collaboration and the maintenance of long-distance ties that would have been impossible decades ago. However, this convenience is not without its costs. The primary critique is that while we are more connected digitally, many individuals feel a growing sense of social isolation and a decline in the quality of face-to-face (FTF) interactions. The constant availability facilitated by mobile devices has blurred the lines between work and personal life, leading to increased stress and a “always on” culture. The very tools designed to bring people together can, paradoxically, push them apart, leading to a focus on “face-to-screen” relationships rather than authentic human interaction. The central theme of this critique is that technological tools are not inherently good or bad, their impact depends on how they are integrated into human life. The challenge lies in navigating this new communication environment to maximize benefits while mitigating the “dark side” of technology, which includes potential addiction, privacy violations and degradation of interpersonal skills.